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IBAT IBANG DISENYO NG SAPATOS, NAG-TAGISAN SA 1ST NATIONAL FOOTWEAR DESIGN COMPETITION SA TAGUIG CITY

NI: TANTAN FRANCISCO

Sa kabila ng maikling panahon para sa pagpapasa ng mga lalahok sa kompetisyon, naging matagumpay ang isinagawang pre-judging para sa kauna-unahang NATIONAL FOOTWEAR DESIGN COMPETITION na ginanap sa DEPARTMENT OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY – PTRI OFFICE BICUTAN TAGUIG CITY. Dinaluhan ng mga hurado mula sa mga nagnenegosyo ng sapatos, Designers, Media, Artist at maging ang OIC ng Department Of Tourism NCR Regional Director Catherine Agustin. Ang kompetisyon

ay inorganisa ng Filipino Footwear Alliance Association (FFAA) sa pangunguna ng Presidente nito na si Ms. Mia Santos, sa pakikipagtulungan ng Department of Science and Technology - Philippine Textile Research Institute (DOST-PTRI) na pinamumunuan ni DIR Julius Leano at ng Department of Trade and Industry - National Capital Region Office (DTI-NCRO). Ayon kay Ms. Mia Santos ng FFAA, nakatanggap ang organisasyon ng mahigit 120 entries mula sa iba’t ibang rehiyon sa Pilipinas, kabilang ang mga

➡ (Sundan sa pahina 2)



PROPEL BUSINESS HUB OPENS TO DRIVE COMMERCIALIZATION OF FILIPINO INNOVATIONS

BY: NELSON SANTOS



The Department of Science and Technology (DOST) formally launched the PROPEL Business Hub and Ex-

hibit Center on March 31, 2026, at the PROPEL Hub-Executive Lounge, DOST Complex along General Santos Avenue

in Taguig City, establishing a collaborative space aimed at accelerating the commercialization of Filipino innova-

tions and strengthening the country’s science, technology, and innovation (STI) ecosystem. ➡ (TURN TO PAGE 3)

Climate Change Commission, Climate Change Task Force, Science and Technology for Environment Progress Oath-Taking Ceremony



For a New Philippines, the newly appointed members of the Climate Change Task Force – Science and Technology

for Environmental Progress (CCTF-STEP) took their oath to fulfill their vital role in protecting ➡ (TURN TO PAGE 2)

Climate Change Commission...

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the environment through science and technology. The Climate Change Task Force (CCTF) operates under the supervision of the Climate Change Commission (CCC). The CCC aims to strengthen the country's preparedness and resilience against the impacts of climate change while promoting smart and innovative solutions to environmental challenges in the Philippines. The oath-taking of the new members and officers reflects the support of BauerTek Pharmaceutical Technologies, Kaibigan sa Kalusugan, and The GlobalLeader Inc. for initiatives aimed at combating climate change. Through tree-planting programs, BauerTek actively contributes to reducing carbon in the environment through carbon sequestration. Led by Scientist/Inventor Richard Nixon Gomez, who has been designated as the National Commander of STEP, the task force will utilize innovative approaches and science-based solutions to address the challenges of climate change in the country. The ceremony was graced by Commissioner Albert P. Dela Cruz of the Climate Change Commission, who also serves as Director General of the Climate Change Task Force. May this serve as an inspiration for everyone to continue fulfilling our responsibilities with integrity, dedication, and genuine concern for the environment and the nation.

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DOST ILOCOS REGION BUILDS DISASTER-READY WORKFORCE THROUGH DRRM CAPACITY BUILDING ACTIVITY



In line with the celebration of Women's Month and Fire Prevention Month, the Department of Science and Technology Ilocos Region (DOST Ilocos Region), through the leadership of Regional Director Terecita A. Tabaog, successfully conducted a Capacity Building Activity on Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) and Disaster Preparedness on March 31, 2026, at the DOST Ilocos Region Multipurpose Hall in City of San Fernando, La Union. The activity brought together the DOST workforce from regional and provincial offices to strengthen their readiness in responding to disasters and emergencies. The morning session opened with Mr. Michael John C. Maquiling, who provided an in-depth overview of the Philippine DRRM System, emphasizing its framework, key pillars, and the roles of various agencies. He highlighted DOST's critical role in delivering science-based solutions and technologies to enhance disaster preparedness and response. Mr. Maquiling also guided participants through the Public Service Continuity Plan (PSCP), ensuring that essential operations can be maintained during emergencies. Following this, Mr. Edrussell S. Castillo introduced the DOST workforce to various DRRM technologies, including HazardHunterPH, GeoAnalyticsPH, PANAHON, and the SOLIDO DRRM Knowledge Hub. He also presented the newly launched HANDA

Integrated Platform, designed to provide accessible, integrated digital solutions for effective disaster risk management. The afternoon session focused on fire safety, led by SFO1 Al Zandruck Macuroy of the Bureau of Fire Protection – San Fernando City, La Union, together with FO1 John Samuel L. Olbinado. They delivered a lecture on Fire Safety and Basic Fire Response in the Workplace, equipping the workforce with essential knowledge on fire prevention, proper response, and workplace safety protocols. Participants then engaged in a hands-on fire drill and fire suppression activity, where they practiced using fire extinguishers and applied safety techniques in simulated emergency scenarios. This practical experience ensured that the workforce could respond effectively during real-life incidents. In her closing remarks, Assistant Regional Director for Technical Services Ms. Racquel Espiritu emphasized the importance of continuous preparedness and reaffirmed DOST's commitment to fostering a safe and resilient workplace. She also highlighted inclusive participation, ensuring that all members of the workforce are equipped with the skills and knowledge to respond to emergencies. This initiative reflects DOST Ilocos Region's commitment to building a disaster-ready workforce capable of managing emergencies, including fire-related incidents, while safeguarding lives, property, and continuity of services.

IBAT IBANG DISENYO NG SAPATOS... MULA PAHINA 1



kalahok mula sa Cebu at Laguna. Ang bilang na ito ay higit sa inaasahan ng mga organizer dahil sa loob lamang ng kulang sa dalawang linggo ay nakalikom sila ng mga dekalidad na disenyo mula sa mga nagnanais maging footwear designers. "Pangunahing kriterya sa kompetisyong ito, ang disenyo ay maging isang showpiece—iyong agaw-atsenyon sa unang tingin pa lang. Ngunit kailangan din na ito ay wearable at walkable, at higit sa lahat, may potensyal na maging isang ganap na negosyo o retail product," pahayag ni Ms. Mia Santos ng FFAA. Mula sa mahigit sandaang kalahok, 18 disenyo lamang ang mapipili para sa shortlist. Ang mga mapipiling disenyo ay aktwal na bubuuin bilang sapatos sa tulong ng mga expert manufacturers mula sa Marikina, Cebu, at Laguna. Ang mga magwawagi ay magkakaroon ng pagkakataong kumatawan sa Pilipinas sa International Footwear Design Competition. Nanawagan din ang FFAA sa mga nagnanais pumasok sa laranigan ng fashion design na makipagtulungan sa mga lokal na platero at sapatero ng Marikina upang bigyang-buhay ang kanilang mga malikhaing ideya. Para sa mga interesadong lumahok o makipagtulungan, maaaring bisitahin ang opisyal na Facebook page ng Filipino Footwear Alliance Association Incorporated. Patunay ang galing at pagkamalikhain ng mga Pilipinong Designers sa larangan ng paggawa ng sapatos. Sa ganitong mga kompetisyon, ipinamalas ng mga lokal na artists ang kanilang kakayahan

na pagsamahin ang sinining, kultura, at likas na yaman ng Pilipinas sa bawat hakbang. Ayon kay Mr. Nelson Ong President of Filipino-Chinese Footwear, isang malaking sorpresa ang kalidad ng mga lahok na disenyo. Aniya, kapansin-pansin ang paggamit ng mga lokal na materyales at ang pagincorporate ng mga sikat na scenic spots ng bansa sa mga sapatos. "Makikita natin 'yung galing ng Pilipino... We were able to make shoes out of the culture, then out of the resources that we had," Naniniwala ang mga eksperto na ang industriya ng sapatos ay hindi lamang para sa moda kundi isang mabisang paraan para i-promote ang turismo ng Pilipinas sa pandaigdigang merkado. Sa pamamagitan ng mga "icons" na nakatatak sa mga disenyo, tila naibebenta na rin ang ganda ng bansa sa bawat makakakita nito. Hamon sa Marikina at Lokal na Designers Bagama't kinikilala ang Marikina bilang Shoe Capital of the Philippines, inamin ng ilang opisyal na may hamon silang kinakaharap kumpara sa ibang bansa sa Asya. Bagama't tayo ang naunang nakilala sa rehiyon, tila nahuhuli na ang bansa pagdating sa modernong produksyon. Gayunpaman, binigyang-pugay ang mga lokal na designers na nananatiling may "passion" sa kanilang sining. Layunin ng mga ganitong aktibidad na muling pasiglahin ang industriya at makahanap ng mga kumpanya o pabrika na susuporta sa mga disenyo para muling makasabay ang Pilipinas sa global market.

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Krishan Joy C. Lacza
PUBLISHER

Jet Claveria
EDITOR IN CHIEF

Minnie Clet
MANAGING EDITOR

Charlene Edora
DESK EDITOR

Martin Banaag / Tantan Francisco
REPORTER

Darell Tropicales
CIRCULATION MANAGER

Eagle Jaime
GRAPHIC DESIGNER

Atty. Evelyn Dominguez / Atty. Eloisa Papa
LEGAL ADVISER

Papi
REBECCA M. VELASQUEZ
President

**PROPEL BUSINESS HUB
OPENS TO DRIVE COM-
MERCIALIZATION...**
FROM PAGE 1



The PROPEL Business Hub is envisioned as a dynamic platform that brings together startups, innovators, scientists, experts, and research institutions, enabling stronger collaboration and bridging the gap between discovery and deployment. It serves as a venue where research outputs can be transformed into market-ready solutions through access to shared facilities, advanced equipment, and technical expertise. Dr. Napoleon K. Juanillo Jr., Assistant Secretary for Technology Transfer, Communications, and Commercialization, emphasized that the hub stands as a platform for turning possibilities into reality by connecting innovators with the scientific community and providing an environment that fosters collaboration and technology development. Meanwhile, Dr. Renato U. Solidum Jr., Secretary of the Department of Science and Technology, highlighted that the initiative enables researchers and startups to benefit from mentorship, incubation, and acceleration programs,

while also opening opportunities for industry matching and technology pitching. He underscored the importance of promoting regional strengths across priority sectors such as agriculture, marine resources, advanced manufacturing, health technologies, and renewable energy. The DOST chief further noted that the establishment of the hub reflects the agency's firm commitment to move beyond research publication toward full commercialization. By strengthening linkages among government, academe, industry, and investors, the PROPEL Business Hub helps build a seamless pipeline from ideation and validation to prototyping, production, and global competitiveness. With the launch of the PROPEL Business Hub and Exhibit Center, DOST reinforces its goal of ensuring that Filipino innovations do not remain on shelves but are translated into real-world applications that drive inclusive economic growth and national development.

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**LUZON SCIENTISTS,
LEADERS CONVENE
FOR 2026 REGIONAL
SCIENTIFIC MEETING**



ALABANG, Muntinlupa City, April 7, 2026 — The 2026 Luzon Regional Scientific Meeting officially opened on April 7, gathering leading scientists, policymakers, industry experts, and development stakeholders from across Luzon to advance science-driven solutions for sustainable development. Organized by the National Academy of Science and Technology, Philippines in partnership with the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) Luzon Cluster, led by Department of Science and Technology – National Capital Region, the two-day event is anchored on the theme “UN SDGs: Science, Technology, and Innovation for Sustainable Development.” Key national figures graced the opening, including Renato U. Solidum Jr., Sancho A. Maborang, Napoleon K. Juanillo Jr., Jaime C. Montoya, and Michael O. Sinocruz. Their participation underscored the importance of collaborative, science-based policymaking in addressing the country's most pressing development challenges. Day 1 sessions centered on assessing Luzon's current progress toward achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), with focused discussions

on passive cooling strategies and pathways toward a net-zero emissions future. Experts highlighted the critical role of innovation in enhancing climate resilience, improving energy efficiency, and promoting sustainable urban development. The meeting, which serves as the first leg of the 2026 Regional Scientific Meetings series, continues on April 8 with two additional plenary sessions tackling emerging priorities: the development of a bioplastics industry roadmap alongside urban waste management solutions, and the application of artificial intelligence (AI)-based prediction systems to address climate-related disasters. Outcomes from the discussions are expected to be consolidated into policy recommendations and endorsed to relevant government agencies, contributing to evidence-based decision-making and strengthening science, technology, and innovation (STI) initiatives across Luzon. The Luzon RSM is part of an annual effort by NAST PHL to convene the country's scientific community and key stakeholders in shaping responsive, forward-looking strategies that align with national and global development goals.

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**BAUERTEK WINS 2 GOLD
MEDALS AND THE MEDICINE
AWARD AT INVENTCOR 2026**



06 April 2026 – Deva, Romania – The Philippines has been honored with 2 Gold Medals and the Medicine Award at the International Exhibition of Inventiveness and Innovation – INVENTCOR 2026. The event recognized BauerTek Pharmaceutical Technologies with its highest honors: 2 gold medals (Jamperine & Pro Nitro Lite) – for outstanding pharmaceutical innovation and technical excellence. Medicine award (BauerTek Farmaceutical Techonology, Inv. Richard Nixon Goemx, CNP & Inv. Rigel Gomez, CNP) – a prestigious Special Distinction honoring their significant contributions to the global healthcare industry. INVENTCOR 2026 featured over 500 invention and projects from more than 40 countries. This recognition celebrates the work of BauerTek and the groundbreaking inventions of father-and-son duo Richard Nixon Gomez and Rigel Gomez. Their award-winning innovations are: Jamperine – most powerful anti-diabetic food supplement PNL Ultra Energy – weight loss, increased endurance, enhanced performance, anti-inflammatory. These milestones highlight BauerTek's work to make healthcare better through innovation.

SHOWBLITZ
By: Charlene Mae
**Magic at Spark,
dinala sa TV5!**



Hmmm, totoo kayang may Kapamilya at Kapuso star na magiging Kapatid na sa paglulunsad ng talent arm ng TV5 na Star Worx sa May 5? Ayaw pang sabihin ng source kung sino 'yun pero kaabang-abang daw talaga. At bongga raw ang line-up ng mga ilulunsad na artist ng Star Worx na pamumunuan ni Mr. Johnny Manahan. Tulad ni Boss Vic del Rosario ng Viva Group of Companies, maituturing na

henyo si Mr. M na nagpasikat sa maraming artista sa kasalukuyan. Na g-u-m-p-i-sa sa Star Magic, hanggang hinawakan ang GMA Artists Center na ginawang Spar-kle ang talent arm ng GMA 7 at ngayon, ang Star Worx ng TV5 ang kanyang hahawakan. Kaya siguradong star material lahat ang mga aalagaan ng TV5. I m a g i n e , pagsasamahin ang magic at spark?

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SPORTS NEWS

Wemby-less Spurs wagi sa Blazers



SAN ANTONIO — Bumira si point guard De’Aaron Fox ng 25 points sa 112-101 pagdaig ng Spurs sa Portland Trail Blazers bagama’t hindi naglaro sina injured Victor Wembanyama at Stephon Castle.

Nagdaig si Keldon Johnson ng 20 points at umiskor si rookie forward Carter Bryant ng season-high 17 markers.

Nagtala ang San Antonio (61-19) ng 28-3 record simula noong Pebrero 1 at ang kanilang best record sapul noong 2017 na kanilang huling pagpasok sa Western Conference Finals sa isang 22-year postseason run tampok ang limang NBA championships.

Kumana si Deni Avdija ng 27 points at may 20 markers si Scoot Henderson para sa Portland (4-40) na laglag sa ikalawang sunod na kabiguan matapos magposte ng isang three-game winning streak.

Matapos kunin ang 61-51 halftime lead sa likod ni Fox ay isinara ng Spurs ang third quarter mula sa isang 13-2 atake para tuluyan nang iwanan ang Trail Blazers sa fourth period.

Sa iba pang laro, pinadapa ng Oklahoma City Thunder ang Los Angeles Clippers, 128-110; tinuhog ng Cleveland Cavaliers ang Atlanta Hawks, 122-116; panalo ang Orlando Magic sa Minnesota Timberwolves, 132-120; wagi ang Detroit Pistons sa Milwaukee Bucks, 137-111; at tinalo ng Denver Nuggets ang Memphis Grizzlies, 136-119.

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09176275522

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